



Flocks of birds, such as these snow pigeons, fly at very high altitudes across the peaks of the Himalayas.

Himalayan snowcock

The mottled colors of the Himalayan snowcock blend in well with the rocks and snow on the high mountain slopes. It eats all sorts of plant material, including roots, tubers, berries, shoots, and seeds, but it often has to search large areas to find enough to eat. In the breeding season, males make whistling calls to impress females.

Himalayan snowcock
(*Tetraogallus himalayensis*)
Length: 2 ft 4 in (72 cm)



Himalayan bulbul
(*Pycnonotus leucotis*)
Length: 7½ in (19 cm)

This species of bulbul has a long crest.

Himalayan bulbul

This lively bulbul lives as high up as 7,000 ft (2,100 m) in the Himalayas. It often perches on the tops of bushes, bowing, flicking its tail, and calling loudly. The Himalayan bulbul is not frightened of people. It is an inquisitive bird that lives near villages and towns and sometimes goes right inside houses to steal food.

Short wings and a long tail are characteristic of bulbuls.



Himalayan monal
(*Lophophorus impejanus*)
Length: 2 ft 4 in (72 cm)

Short, strong legs for mountain climbing

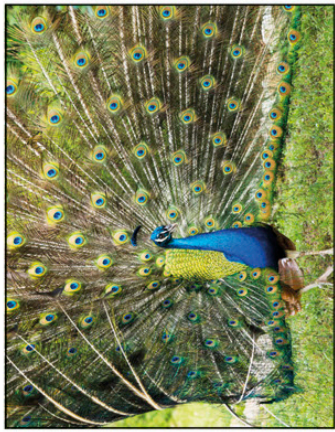
Himalayan monal

This pheasant lives in the forests and meadows of the Himalayas, moving up and down the mountains with the seasons. It uses its powerful, curved bill as a digging tool to uncover roots, bulbs, and insect grubs. To display to a female, the male raises his crest, fluffs out his shiny neck feathers, fans his tail, and droops his wings.

Male

Female

Female's brown feathers help camouflage her on the nest.



A male common peafowl displays his magnificent feathers. Many other spectacular pheasants live in the forests of the Himalayas.

Common hill mynah

The noisy hill mynah lives in the tops of forest trees on the lower mountain slopes, feeding mainly on fruits and nectar. It makes a wide variety of whistling calls and is a brilliant mimic of the human voice. People have taken many of these birds from the wild to be kept as "talking" pets.

Bright yellow face wattles (folds of skin) stand out against the glossy black feathers.

Common hill mynah
(*Gracula religiosa*)
Length: 1 ft (31 cm)